

They had turned into enormous pigs! Circe laughed, then drove them into a pen behind her house.

When his men did not return, Odysseus set out in search of them. On his way to Circe's house, the god Hermes appeared before him. Hermes liked Odysseus and wanted to warn him. "Be careful, Odysseus," said Hermes. "This is the home of the witch Circe and she has turned your men into pigs. To rescue them, you need to take this root and mix it into the food Circe offers. It will protect you from the same fate."



Thanking the god, Odysseus continued on his way. At Circe's house, he too was invited in to eat, but he mixed the magical root with his meal. Circe was very surprised when he did not change into a pig. Instead, Odysseus challenged her, "Circe, if you do not restore my men to me, I will kill you!"

Circe was afraid. "If he can resist my spells, he must be very powerful," she thought. "Please, forgive me," she begged. "I will turn your men back into humans, and you can rest in my home as long as you like." Odysseus agreed, and they stayed with Circe for an entire year.